



Email Migration *to Google Workspace*

Move every kclinics.co.uk mailbox off Hostinger with no lost email, at the lowest sustainable cost — turning role addresses into free aliases and groups — and end up managing every Workspace account from the admin dashboard.

CONTENTS

What's inside

Parts 1 to 5 are the decisions and prep. Parts 6 to 11 are the migration itself, written click-by-click. Part 16 is the developer spec for managing Workspace from /admin (BLD-312). The appendices are tick-box runbooks to print.

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01 · PART

How to use this guide

This guide moves every company mailbox at kclinics.co.uk from Hostinger to Google Workspace without losing a single email, for the lowest ongoing cost, and sets you up to manage all Workspace accounts from your own admin dashboard. You do not need to be technical to follow the owner steps.

The golden rule

IMPORTANT

Your old Hostinger mailboxes stay switched on and untouched until the very end. Every step here COPIES mail into Google; nothing is moved or deleted at the source until you have checked the copy. If anything looks wrong, you roll back by pointing one DNS record back at Hostinger.

Two audiences, one document

- **Owner / manager** — Parts 1 to 9 and 11 to 20, plus the appendices: numbered, plain-English steps.
- **Developer** — Part 16 is the build spec for managing Workspace from /admin, tracked on the Build board as BLD-312.

Roughly how long

A quiet evening for Phases 1 to 4, the cutover on a low-traffic morning, then a one-to-two-week safety window before you close anything at Hostinger. You can stop and resume at any point up to the cutover.



02 • PART

Where you are today

Two facts about the current setup decide the whole migration. Read this before touching anything.

THING	TODAY	WHERE IT LIVES
Staff mailboxes (the inboxes people log into)	Hostinger webmail	Hostinger
Shared clinic calendar	Hostinger (CalDAV)	Hostinger
App email: confirmations, reminders, campaigns	Resend	mail.kclinics.co.uk
Chat replies / inbound routing	Resend Inbound	reply.mail.kclinics.co.uk
Website	Vercel	apex A / CNAME
DNS records	Cloudflare	where Resend / Turnstile records live
Domain registrar	Hostinger	—

The two facts that make this safe

- **Resend uses subdomains, not the apex** — it sends and receives on mail. and reply.mail., which carry their own mail (MX) records. Pointing the bare kclinics.co.uk at Google does not touch Resend, so the platform keeps sending and receiving exactly as before.
- **The app already replies to apex addresses** — EMAIL_REPLY_TO is hello@kclinics.co.uk and CLINIC_NOTIFY_EMAIL is frontend@kclinics.co.uk. The moment those addresses live in Workspace, customer replies and booking alerts land in Gmail with no code or settings change.

IMPORTANT

Check who actually controls DNS before you start. The records are in Cloudflare, but the domain is registered at Hostinger. Look up the nameservers (whatsmydns.net, or run "dig NS kclinics.co.uk"). If they say *.ns.cloudflare.com, make every DNS change in Cloudflare; if they point at Hostinger, make them there. Everywhere below that says "in your DNS provider" means this one.

03 · PART

The cost model — pay the least

Google Workspace bills per user mailbox (a "seat"). Almost everything else is free. The whole strategy: buy a seat only for a real person who must log in and send as themselves; turn every other address into a free alias or group.

The three ways to hold an address (only one costs money)

MECHANISM	COST	USE IT FOR
User (seat)	Paid, per month	A real human who logs in, sends and stores mail
Alias on a user	Free (up to 30)	A second name for one person — mail lands in their Gmail
Group (Collaborative Inbox)	Free	A shared role address several people answer

One person owns a role address → make it an ALIAS. Several people share it → make it a GROUP. Neither costs a seat. This single decision is where the savings are.

Pick the cheapest edition that fits

EDITION (APPROX UK, EARLY 2026)	STORAGE	CHOOSE IT WHEN
Business Starter ~£5–6 /user/mo	30 GB	Default. Plenty for a clinic inbox. Pick this unless forced up.
Business Standard ~£10–12 /user/mo	2 TB	You need Vault retention, Meet recording, or UK/EU data region
Business Plus ~£18 /user/mo	5 TB	Heavier compliance / storage only

TIP

Confirm live prices at workspace.google.com/pricing before committing — editions and the bundled Gemini AI changed in 2025.

Cost notes that move the bill

- **Flexible vs Annual** — Flexible = pay monthly, change seats anytime, slightly dearer. Annual = about 20% cheaper but you commit a seat count for a year. Start on Flexible through the migration; move the stable core seats to Annual once headcount settles.
- **Mix editions** — Starter for most staff, Standard only for the one mailbox that needs Vault. Buy the expensive tier only where it is required.
- **Suspended is not free** — a suspended user keeps all their mail but may still consume a paid licence. To actually stop paying for a seat you remove its licence or delete the account, and only after its mail is exported (Part 19).

- **Free trial** — 14 days. Do the whole test migration inside it before any card is charged.

Inventory — fill this in before you buy anything

List every address that exists or forwards at Hostinger and mark each one. Seats are the only column you pay for.

ADDRESS	DECISION	WHY
hello@	Group	shared, customer-facing; app replies-to here
frontdesk@	Group	shared; app booking alerts land here
info@ / support@	Group, or alias of hello@	shared / duplicate of hello
inna.k@ (a real person)	Seat	a human who sends as herself
owner@ / joe@	Seat (super-admin)	runs the account
each clinician	Seat	sends as themselves
departed staff	Alias/forward, then archive	do not pay for a leaver
chat@mail. / replies@reply.mail.	Leave alone	these belong to Resend, not Workspace

TIP

Illustrative maths: say 6 real staff need to send as themselves and there are 6 role addresses. Lowest cost = 6 seats, with all 6 role addresses free as groups/aliases. The naive "a seat per address" way is 12 seats — double the bill, forever. Replace the numbers with your real headcount.

04 · PART

The plan at a glance

Seven phases. Only Phase 5 changes where new mail goes; everything before it is invisible to live mail.

Phase 1	Sign up + verify the domain (TXT only)	-> no effect on live mail
Phase 2	Create seats, groups and aliases	-> no effect on live mail
Phase 3	Pre-copy ALL old mail in (Data Migration Svc)	-> reads Hostinger, copies to Google
Phase 4	Turn on Google sending auth (SPF/DKIM/DMARC)	-> does NOT touch Resend
Phase 5	Cutover: point the APEX mailbox (MX) at Google	-> new mail now lands in Gmail
Phase 6	Delta re-copy + verify	-> catch mail that arrived mid-switch
Phase 7	Grace period, then decommission Hostinger	-> only after everything verified

Realistic timeline: a quiet evening for Phases 1 to 4, the cutover on a low-traffic morning, then a one-to-two-week grace period before decommissioning.

05 · PART

Pre-flight checklist

Gather these once and the rest goes quickly. Most are things you already have as a business owner.

- ☐ A password manager ready (you will create several strong passwords).
- ☐ Admin access to the DNS provider (Part 2 — Cloudflare or Hostinger) and to the Hostinger email control panel.
- ☐ The Part 3 inventory completed and agreed.
- ☐ For each mailbox you are migrating: its IMAP login — server host, username (the full email) and password (or an app password if the mailbox has 2FA). Hostinger IMAP is typically `imap.hostinger.com`, port 993, SSL.
- ☐ A maintenance window chosen for the cutover (early morning is calmest).
- ☐ Staff told: "On <date> your email moves to Gmail. Keep using the old webmail until then; we will send your new login."

06 · PART

Phase 1 — Sign up and prove you own the domain

Safe: no mail moves. You create the account and add one TXT record.

- 1 Go to workspace.google.com and click "Get started". Enter the business name, number of staff and country (United Kingdom).
 - 2 When asked "Does your business have a domain?", choose "Yes, I have one" and type kclinics.co.uk.
 - 3 Create the first admin account — this is your master login and super-admin (e.g. owner@kclinics.co.uk). Use a strong password and turn on 2-Step Verification immediately.
 - 4 Choose Business Starter and the Flexible plan. Do not add extra seats yet. The 14-day trial means no charge during setup.
 - 5 Google gives you a TXT record to verify the domain. In your DNS provider add it: Type TXT, Name @, Content = the `google-site-verification=...` value Google shows, then Save.
 - 6 Back in Google, click Verify. This only proves ownership — it does not change where email goes. Live mail is still flowing to Hostinger.
- **Verify your domain** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/60216>

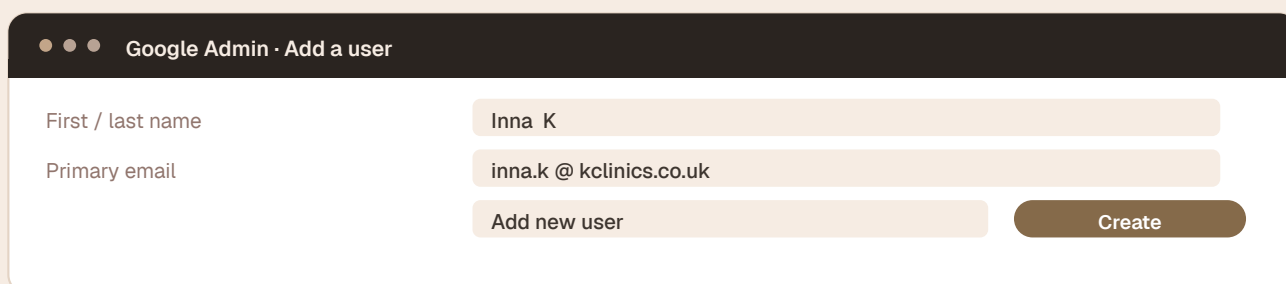
07 · PART

Phase 2 — Create seats, groups and aliases

Still no mail moved. All of this is in the Google Admin console at admin.google.com.

SEATS (REAL PEOPLE)

- 1 Directory → Users → Add new user.
- 2 Enter their name and primary email (e.g. inna.k@kclinics.co.uk) — match the existing address exactly so their migrated mail history lines up.
- 3 Save, and give them the auto-generated password to change on first login.



The screenshot shows the 'Google Admin · Add a user' form. It has two input fields: 'First / last name' with the value 'Inna K' and 'Primary email' with the value 'inna.k @ kclinics.co.uk'. Below these fields are two buttons: 'Add new user' and 'Create'.

ALIASES (FREE SECOND NAMES FOR ONE PERSON)

- 1 Directory → Users, click the person.
- 2 User information → Email aliases → Add an alias (e.g. add inna@ as an alias of inna.k@). Mail to the alias lands in their Gmail; they can "Send mail as" it.

GROUPS (FREE SHARED INBOXES)

- 1 Directory → Groups → Create group. Name it (e.g. "Front Desk") and set the group email to the role address (hello@kclinics.co.uk).
- 2 Add the staff who should answer it as members.
- 3 Open the group → Settings: set "Who can post" to Anyone on the web (so customers can email it) and enable Collaborative Inbox so staff can assign and resolve messages.

- **Add users** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/33310>
- **Add email aliases** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/33327>
- **Create a group + Collaborative Inbox** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/167430>

IMPORTANT

Do not recreate chat@mail... or replies@reply.mail... — those belong to Resend and must stay exactly where they are (Part 13).

08 • PART

Phase 3 — Pre-copy all existing mail in

Google's free, built-in Data Migration Service (DMS) copies mail over IMAP. It reads from Hostinger and writes to Gmail, and never deletes or changes anything on Hostinger. Run it now, before cutover, so the bulk is already in Gmail when you flip the switch.

- 1 Admin console → Account → Data migration (or Apps → Data migration).
 - 2 Migration source: choose "Other IMAP server" (Hostinger is generic IMAP).
 - 3 Connection protocol IMAP; server `imap.hostinger.com` (confirm in the Hostinger panel), with the role/admin mailbox credentials.
 - 4 Migration start date: choose "migrate everything" (no start date) for a full history copy.
 - 5 Select users: map each source Hostinger mailbox to its destination Workspace user from Phase 2, using each mailbox's IMAP password (or app password).
 - 6 Start the migration and let it run. Large mailboxes take hours — that is fine, nothing is offline.
- **Migrate email with the Data Migration Service** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/6167866>
 - **IMAP migration specifics** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/7044263>

What IMAP migration does not carry

- **Contacts** — in Hostinger webmail export contacts to CSV, then Google Contacts → Import.
- **Calendar** — export any Hostinger calendar to .ics and import it in Google Calendar (Settings → Import & export). The shared clinic calendar is created fresh in Workspace; re-share it with staff (Part 15).

TIP

For up to ~100 mailboxes DMS is the right tool. (Google Workspace Migrate, the heavyweight alternative, needs a Windows server and is overkill for a clinic.)

09 · PART

Phase 4 — Turn on Google's sending authentication

This makes mail sent from Gmail as @kclinics.co.uk pass spam checks. Resend's own SPF/DKIM live on the mail. subdomain and are left exactly as they are.

SPF (APEX)

In your DNS provider find any existing apex TXT that starts v=spf1 (Hostinger may have added one) and replace its value with the line below. There must be only ONE SPF record on the apex. Resend's SPF is a separate record on mail.kclinics.co.uk — do not merge or remove it.

```
v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all
```

DKIM (APEX)

- 1 Admin console → Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Authenticate email.
- 2 Generate new record (2048-bit). Google gives a TXT for host google._domainkey.
- 3 Add that TXT in your DNS provider, then come back and click "Start authentication".

DMARC (APEX)

Add a TXT at host _dmarc (skip if one already exists — tighten it instead). Start gentle so nothing is rejected mid-migration, then after a clean week raise p=none to quarantine, then reject.

```
v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:postmaster@kclinics.co.uk; fo=1
```

- **Set up DKIM** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/174124>
- **Add a DMARC record** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/2466580>

TIP

Relaxed alignment (the default) means Resend's subdomain mail keeps passing DMARC, so tightening the policy does not break the platform's email.

10 · PART

Phase 5 — Cutover: point the apex at Google

The only step that changes where new mail for @kclinics.co.uk lands.

- 1 The day before, in your DNS provider lower the TTL on the apex MX record(s) to 300 seconds (5 min). This makes rollback fast.
- 2 On the morning of cutover, remove the old Hostinger apex MX records and add Google's single MX record below.
- 3 Do NOT change the mail. or reply.mail. records (Part 13) — they are different hostnames with their own MX and are unaffected.
- 4 Wait for propagation (usually minutes with the lowered TTL; allow up to an hour). Send a test from an outside account to hello@kclinics.co.uk and confirm it arrives in the Workspace Group.

TYPE	NAME	MAIL SERVER	PRIORITY
MX	@ (apex)	smtp.google.com	1

If your panel insists on the legacy set, use Google's five ASPMX records instead (the Admin console shows them). Either works; do not mix.

- **Set up MX records for Gmail** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/140034>

TIP

Belt-and-braces (optional): in the Hostinger panel set each old mailbox to also forward a copy to its new address during the switch. Combined with the Phase 6 delta copy, this guarantees zero gap.

11 • PART

Phase 6 & 7 — Delta copy, verify, grace period

Catch anything that arrived mid-switch, verify, then keep Hostinger as a safety net.

- 1 Re-run the Data Migration Service for each mailbox (same setup as Phase 3). DMS pulls only what is new, sweeping up anything that hit Hostinger between the first copy and the MX cutover. Nothing is duplicated.
- 2 Verify against the test matrix in Appendix B before declaring done.
- 3 Keep the Hostinger mailboxes live and paid for one to two weeks after cutover as a safety net (and so any straggler mail or forward still resolves).
- 4 Only once Appendix B passes and staff confirm nothing is missing do you move to decommission (Part 19).

12 · PART

Aliases and groups playbook

The money-saver, in detail. For each role/shared address, decide and apply one of these. All three cost nothing ongoing.

BECOMES AN ALIAS WHEN ONE PERSON OWNS IT

Admin console → Directory → Users → [person] → Email aliases → Add an alias. Their Gmail now also receives anything sent to the alias, and they can "Send mail as" it (Gmail → Settings → Accounts → "Send mail as"). Cost: nil.

BECOMES A GROUP WHEN SEVERAL PEOPLE SHARE IT

Admin console → Directory → Groups → Create group with the role address, add the team as members, enable Collaborative Inbox. Everyone sees it, can claim, reply and mark resolved. Cost: nil.

BECOMES A FORWARD, THEN NOTHING, FOR A LEAVER OR DEAD ADDRESS

Make it an alias/forward to the relevant manager so nothing bounces, archive the old mailbox's contents to that manager (Part 19), then drop the source seat. Cost: nil ongoing.

TIP

Keep the per-person alias count under 30. If a single inbox needs more than 30 names, that is a sign it should be a Group instead.

13 · PART

Keep Resend and the website working

The rule is simple: only the apex's mail (MX), SPF, DKIM and DMARC change. Everything on the mail. and reply.mail. subdomains is left alone.

DO NOT TOUCH — THESE BELONG TO RESEND / VERCEL

RECORD	HOST	IF YOU BREAK IT
SPF (v=spf1 ... resend ...)	mail.kclinics.co.uk	App emails go to spam
DKIM CNAME / TXT	*._domainkey.mail.kclinics.co.uk	App emails fail signing
MX + CNAME + CAA	reply.mail.kclinics.co.uk	Chat replies stop threading
A / CNAME	@ and www	Website goes down

CHANGE / ADD — THESE ARE THE MIGRATION (APEX ONLY)

RECORD	HOST	ACTION
MX	@	Remove Hostinger's; add smtp.google.com (pri 1)
SPF TXT	@	Replace apex value with v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all
DKIM TXT	google._domainkey	Add (from Admin console)
DMARC TXT	_dmarc	Add p=none, tighten later
Verification TXT	@	Temporary; remove after verifying

Because mail. and reply.mail. are separate hostnames, their MX records are read independently of the apex. Google receiving on kclinics.co.uk and Resend receiving on reply.mail.kclinics.co.uk coexist with zero conflict.

14 · PART

DNS reference — before and after

The whole zone at a glance. Only the bottom block changes.

```
# Website (unchanged) -----
@           A/CNAME    -> Vercel
www         CNAME      -> Vercel

# App email via Resend (UNCHANGED -- do not edit) -----
mail        TXT         v=spf1 include:resend ... ~all
*._domainkey CNAME/TXT   (Resend DKIM)
reply.mail  MX/CNAME/CAA (Resend Inbound)

# Company mailboxes via Google Workspace (THIS migration) -----
@           MX          smtp.google.com (priority 1)      <- was Hostinger
@           TXT          v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all <- replace apex SPF
google._domainkey TXT     (Google DKIM, from Admin console)
_dmarc      TXT          v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:postmaster@kclinics.co.uk
```

15 · PART

What changes in the platform

Almost nothing, by design.

AREA	CHANGE?	DETAIL
Resend sending (EMAIL_FROM)	No	Keep sending from the mail.kclinics.co.uk subdomain. Do not switch EMAIL_FROM to an apex address.
EMAIL_REPLY_TO = hello@	No	Already an apex address; once hello@ is a Workspace Group, replies land in Gmail.
CLINIC_NOTIFY_EMAIL = frontdesk@	No	Same — booking alerts land in the Workspace Group.
Chat inbound (reply.mail.)	No	Stays on Resend Inbound.
Shared calendar	Optional	Revive the parked Google Calendar sync (GOOGLE_INTEGRATION_ENABLED=true) and retire the HOSTINGER_CALDAV_* vars.

Net result: the mailbox migration needs no env changes to keep the live site sending and receiving. The only optional follow-up is moving the calendar sync from Hostinger CalDAV to Google.

16 · PART

Manage Workspace from /admin (BLD-312)

Goal: create/suspend users, manage aliases and groups, and see seat usage from the admin dashboard without logging into the Google Admin console. This is a build task; the spec below matches the patterns already in the codebase. (Developer-facing.)

AUTHENTICATION — SERVICE ACCOUNT + DOMAIN-WIDE DELEGATION

Directory operations need a super-admin context. For a single internal tool, use a Google Cloud service account with domain-wide delegation (DWD) that impersonates a designated super-admin (e.g. admin@kclinics.co.uk). No per-request user OAuth, no interactive re-consent.

- 1 In the same Google Cloud project as the existing GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID, enable the Admin SDK API.
- 2 Create a service account and a JSON key.
- 3 Admin console → Security → API controls → Domain-wide delegation: authorise the service account client ID for the admin.directory scopes (use the .readonly variants for Phase A).
- 4 Store the credentials encrypted via the existing managed-secrets pattern (setSecret → encryptJson): GOOGLE_WORKSPACE_SA_KEY (the JSON), GOOGLE_WORKSPACE_ADMIN_EMAIL (the super-admin to impersonate), GOOGLE_WORKSPACE_CUSTOMER_ID (optional, defaults to my_customer).

NEW LIBRARY — LIB/GOOGLE-WORKSPACE.TS

Follow the hand-rolled token style already in lib/google-auth.ts (the codebase calls Google token endpoints directly with fetch rather than pulling in the googleapis SDK; jose is already a dependency for signing).

```
workspaceConfigured(): Promise<boolean> // SA key + admin email present
directoryToken(scopes): Promise<string> // jose-signed SA JWT, sub=admin,
// exchange at oauth2.googleapis.com, cache
listWorkspaceUsers() / getWorkspaceUser(email)
createWorkspaceUser(input) / suspendWorkspaceUser(email) / restoreWorkspaceUser(email)
deleteWorkspaceUser(email) // guard hard; only post-archive
addUserAlias(email, alias) / removeUserAlias(email, alias)
listGroups() / createGroup(email, name)
addGroupMember(group, member) / removeGroupMember(group, member)
```

Every function returns a safe no-op when workspaceConfigured() is false, so the feature stays dormant until the key is supplied (the inert-until-credentialed pattern in INTEGRATIONS.md).

ROUTES — APP/API/ADMIN/INTEGRATIONS/GOOGLE-WORKSPACE/*

Reuse the integrations route convention. Because auth is a service account, there is no connect/callback pair; instead a "paste the service-account key + Test" form saves the secret via setSecret.

ROUTE	METHOD	PURPOSE
.../test	GET	workspaceConfigured() + a user count to prove the connection

.../users	GET / POST	list / create users
.../users/[email]	PATCH / DELETE	suspend-restore / delete
.../users/[email]/aliases	POST / DELETE	add / remove alias
.../groups	GET / POST	list / create groups
.../groups/[email]/members	POST / DELETE	add / remove member

Gate every handler with `sessionCan(session, "settings.manage")` (or a new `workspace.manage` permission) and call `logAudit` on every write, exactly as the `google-business` callback does.

UI, REGISTRATION AND THE STAFF TIE-IN

- **New page** — `app/admin/workspace/page.tsx`: a Users table (status, last login, storage, suspend/alias actions) and a Groups tab, gated on the same permission, mirroring `app/admin/staff/page.tsx`.
- **Register** — a nav entry in `lib/admin-nav.ts` and an entry in `getIntegrations()` (`lib/integrations.ts`) so it shows on the Integrations page with a status + `manageHref`.
- **Staff lifecycle** — on create of an active `AdminUser` with an `@kclinics.co.uk` email, offer "Create Workspace mailbox"; on deactivate, offer "Suspend Workspace mailbox". No schema change needed — resolve the Workspace user by `AdminUser.email`; add only nullable, additive fields later if you cache the link.

BUILD IT IN PHASES

- **Phase A — read-only** — `.readonly` scopes; dashboard lists users, groups, aliases, last-login and storage. Proves the auth and powers the Part 3 seat audit.
- **Phase B — provisioning** — write scopes; create/suspend users, manage aliases and group membership; wire into staff create/deactivate.
- **Phase C — automation** — auto-provision on staff create, auto-suspend on deactivate, and surface seat usage vs licences so the owner can prune unused seats.

SECURITY

The service-account key can administer every account — store it only via `setSecret` (encrypted with `encryptJson`), grant least-privilege scopes (start read-only), gate the UI behind an owner-level permission, `logAudit` every write, and keep the impersonated admin a dedicated super-admin with 2-Step Verification.

17 · PART

Rollback

If anything is wrong after the MX cutover, you recover in minutes because nothing at the source was deleted.

- 1 In your DNS provider, revert the apex MX back to Hostinger's values (you lowered the TTL to 300s in Phase 5, so this propagates fast).
- 2 New mail flows to Hostinger again; the Workspace copies you already migrated stay intact.
- 3 Diagnose, fix, and re-attempt the cutover. No mail is lost either way because both sides retain their copies.

IMPORTANT

Keep Hostinger paid until you have decided NOT to roll back (the Part 11 grace period).

18 · PART

Security and compliance (clinic-specific)

A clinic has record-keeping duties; decide these before, not after.

- **Enforce 2-Step Verification** — for all staff (Admin → Security → Authentication). Non-negotiable for a clinic.
- **Retention / eDiscovery** — if you must retain or legally-hold email, that is Google Vault, which needs Business Standard or above. Put the owner/records mailbox on Standard and leave the rest on Starter, or use a third-party backup. Decide before, not after.
- **Data region** — UK/EU data-region controls also require Standard or above. Note it if your DPO requires data residency.
- **Leavers** — suspend (do not delete) on day one to preserve evidence; transfer/export, then delete after your retention window, updating the Part 3 inventory so you stop paying.
- **Record it** — note the change in docs/COMPLIANCE_ROADMAP.md if email handling is referenced there.

19 · PART

Decommission Hostinger

Only after the Part 11 grace period passes and staff confirm nothing is missing.

- 1 Confirm Appendix B passes and staff report nothing missing.
- 2 For any mailbox you are closing, do a final delta DMS run (Phase 6) so the last few days of mail are in Google.
- 3 Export a local archive of each old mailbox you are not keeping (Hostinger webmail export, or one last IMAP pull) and store it with your records.
- 4 Turn off any Hostinger email forwarding you set up in Phase 5.
- 5 Cancel the Hostinger email/mailbox plan. KEEP the domain registration and KEEP DNS as-is — you are only stopping the mailbox service.
- 6 Remove the now-unused `HOSTINGER_CALDAV_*` env vars if you moved the calendar to Google (Part 15).

20 • PART

Ongoing cost control

Keep the bill at its floor.

- **Review seats vs licences monthly** — Phase C surfaces this in /admin.
- **New shared address = Group or alias, never a seat** — make it the default question whenever anyone asks for "a new email address".
- **Suspend leavers immediately** — delete (after archiving) at the end of the retention window so you stop paying.
- **Annual for the core** — move stable core seats to the Annual plan once headcount is steady; keep new or seasonal staff on Flexible.
- **Re-confirm pricing at renewal** — editions and bundled features change.

APPENDIX

Appendix A — per-mailbox runbook

Repeat for each mailbox in the Part 3 inventory.

- ☐ Decision recorded (Seat / Alias / Group / Archive-and-drop).
- ☐ IMAP login captured (host, user, app password).
- ☐ Destination created in Workspace (user / alias / group).
- ☐ Phase 3 full copy done.
- ☐ Contacts CSV + calendar .ics imported (if a real person).
- ☐ Phase 6 delta copy done (post-cutover).
- ☐ Owner spot-checked: oldest mail, newest mail, a folder, an attachment.
- ☐ (Leaver only) archived locally, source seat dropped.

APPENDIX

Appendix B — post-cutover test matrix

Tick every line before you decommission Hostinger.

- ☐ External → hello@ lands in the Workspace Group inbox.
- ☐ External → frontend@ lands in the Group; app booking alert visible.
- ☐ External → a person's seat (e.g. inna.k@) lands in their Gmail.
- ☐ Reply from Gmail "as" hello@ shows the right From address.
- ☐ Book a test appointment → confirmation email still sends (Resend).
- ☐ Reply to a booking email → lands at hello@ in Workspace.
- ☐ Live-chat email reply → still threads (reply.mail. on Resend, untouched).
- ☐ Old mail present: oldest message, newest message, a folder, an attachment.
- ☐ DKIM/SPF/DMARC pass (send to mail-tester.com — aim 10/10).
- ☐ mxtoolbox.com shows apex MX = smtp.google.com; mail. records unchanged.

APPENDIX

Appendix C — official references

Google's own help articles, kept current with live screenshots.

- **Workspace setup overview** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/53926>
- **Verify your domain** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/60216>
- **Set up Gmail MX records** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/140034>
- **Add users** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/33310>
- **Email aliases** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/33327>
- **Groups + Collaborative Inbox** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/167430>
- **Data Migration Service** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/6167866>
- **IMAP migration** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/7044263>
- **Set up DKIM** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/174124>
- **Add a DMARC record** <https://support.google.com/a/answer/2466580>
- **Admin SDK Directory API** <https://developers.google.com/admin-sdk/directory>
- **Domain-wide delegation** <https://developers.google.com/identity/protocols/oauth2/service-account>
- **Workspace pricing** <https://workspace.google.com/pricing>